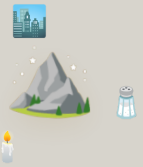
STUDY AID · MATTHEW 5:1-20 · EPISODE 6 OF 58

# Hearts Fit for *the Kingdom*



*The 'secret enemy' looked the most obedient of all.*

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 5:1-20 in the LSB | 27:31 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: The SECRET Enemy in Jesus' Sermon on the Mount REVEALED! (Matthew 5:1-20). Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT · ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

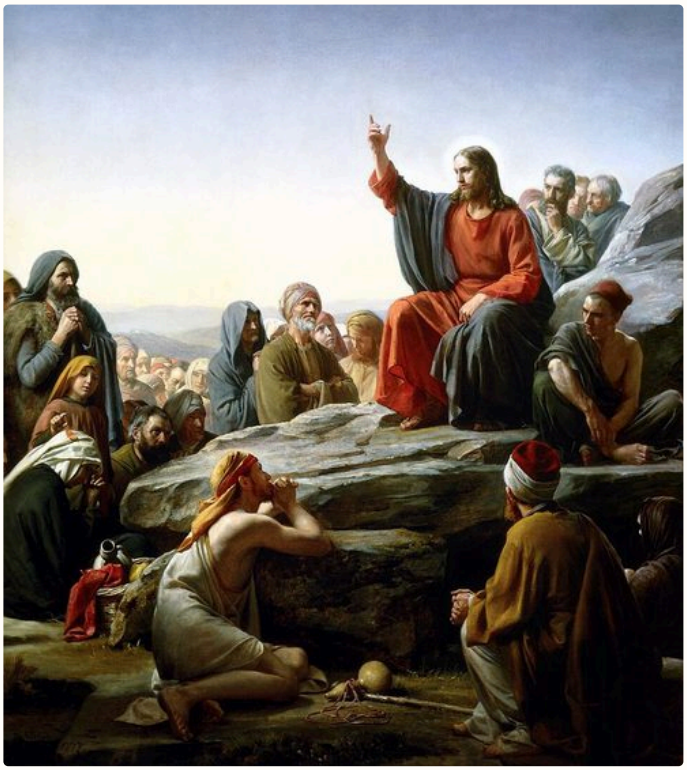
01 · FROM THE VIDEO

## Short summary

- The teacher reads Matthew 5:1-20: Jesus sits down on the mountain and teaches the Beatitudes, calls His disciples salt and light, and says He came not to abolish the Law and the Prophets but to fulfill them.
- Jesus sits to teach, as rabbis did, and He gives God's commands from a mountain, as Moses did. The Sermon on the Mount is the first of five great teaching blocks in Matthew, and the teacher links the five to the five books of the Torah.
- 'Kingdom of heaven' is the theme. It bookends the Beatitudes (verses 3 and 10), which the teacher reads as a chiasm, a mountain-shaped pattern whose peak is 'Blessed are the merciful' (verse 7), echoing Psalm 18:25.
- Old Testament keys: Isaiah 61 behind the first Beatitudes (Jesus had already read it in the Nazareth synagogue); the covenant of salt (Leviticus 2:13; Numbers 18:19); and the lampstand in God's house, shaped like a tree.
- 'Abolish' and 'fulfill,' the teacher says, were Jewish idioms for misinterpreting and rightly interpreting the Torah. Jesus came to teach it rightly.
- The 'secret enemy': the scribes and Pharisees (5:20), who looked obedient but were not changed in heart. The lesson: it is possible to live thinking you obey God's commands and still not enter His kingdom. The difference is the heart.

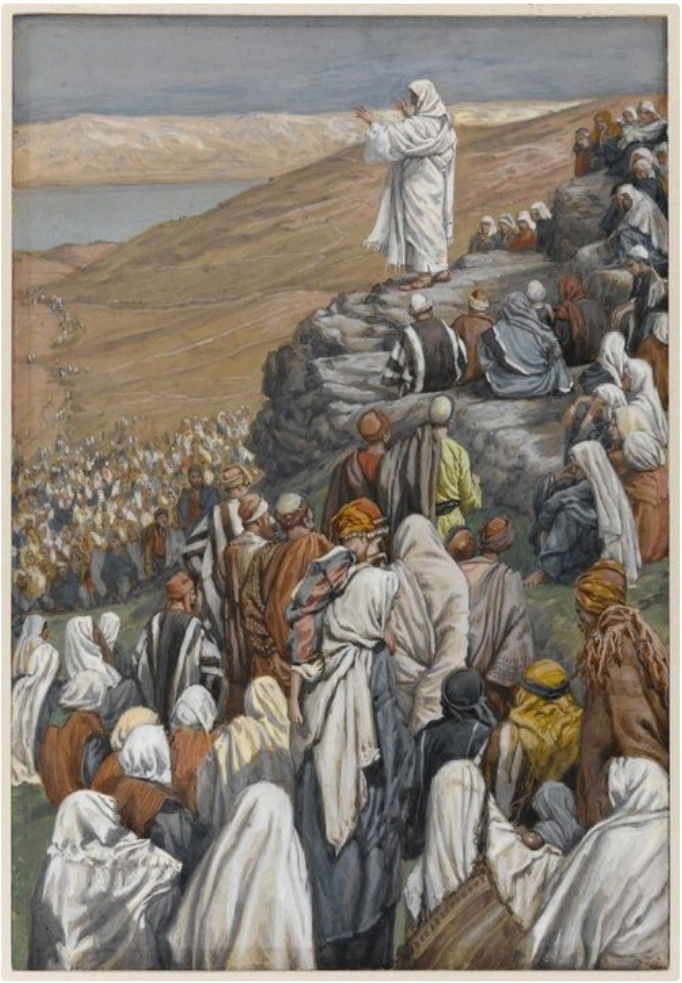
> *"There is a secret enemy in Jesus' Sermon on the Mount, and it's right in the first several verses.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

> *"When we read the Bible, we really have to do so over the shoulder of a Jew.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)



*'He opened His mouth and began to teach them' (5:2)*

Carl Bloch, The Sermon on the Mount, 1877. Via Wikimedia Commons, public domain



*The Beatitudes (5:3-10)*

James Tissot, The Sermon of the Beatitudes, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

### Read it over the shoulder of a Jew

The teacher's rule for this passage: ask what a Jewish listener would hear. A mountain recalls Moses. Salt recalls the covenant. A lamp on a stand in a house recalls the lampstand in God's house. So for each image in verses 1-20, look for the Old Testament text it brings to mind, then come back to Jesus.

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB.

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

## Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 5:1-20, then the Old Testament texts behind it. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

**Matthew 5:1-20**
Read in full: the Beatitudes, salt and light, and Jesus and the Law.

**Isaiah 61:1-3**
Good news to the afflicted, comfort for all who mourn: the video reads it beside 5:3-5.

### Luke 4:16–21
Jesus reads Isaiah 61 in the Nazareth synagogue: 'Today this Scripture has been fulfilled in your hearing.'

### Psalm 18:25–26
The video's Old Testament echo for 'Blessed are the merciful' (5:7).

### Leviticus 2:13
'The salt of the covenant of your God shall not be lacking.'

### Numbers 18:19
'An everlasting covenant of salt before Yahweh.'

### 2 Chronicles 13:5
God gave David's house the kingdom 'by a covenant of salt.'

### Luke 10:1
The video's example of the wider circle of disciples: the seventy sent out in pairs.

### Matthew 23:27–28
Later, Jesus' 'whitewashed tombs': beautiful outside, full of uncleanness inside.

### Matthew 5:21–48
Coming next (Episode 7): 'You have heard that it was said… but I say to you.'

## Key verses in the LSB

“Blessed are the merciful, for they shall receive mercy.”
Matthew 5:7 (LSB)

“You are the salt of the earth”
Matthew 5:13 (LSB)

“Do not think that I came to abolish the Law or the Prophets; I did not come to abolish but to fulfill.”
Matthew 5:17 (LSB)

“For I say to you that unless your righteousness surpasses that of the scribes and Pharisees, you will not enter the kingdom of heaven.”
Matthew 5:20 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

# On the mountain, like Moses

How Matthew sets the scene in 5:1-2, and what a Jewish listener would hear in it.



LIKE MOSES · MATTHEW 5:1

### He went up on the mountain

MOSES · EXODUS 19:3
“Now Moses went up to God, and Yahweh called to him from the mountain”

JESUS · MATTHEW 5:1
“Now when Jesus saw the crowds, He went up on the mountain”

FROM THE VIDEO Someone else in the Old Testament gave God's commands from a mountaintop: Moses. And Moses promised one like him whom God's people must listen to. This is Jesus, giving the teaching of God from the mountaintop.

BACKGROUND Moses' promise: 'Yahweh your God will raise up for you a prophet like me ... you shall listen to him' (Deuteronomy 18:15). Episode 4 traced the same Moses pattern in the wilderness tests. Deuteronomy 18:15-18 Exodus 24:12

◆ Factbook: Moses ◆ Factbook: Mount Sinai (Horeb) ◆ Factbook: Book of Deuteronomy



TEACHING POSTURE · MATTHEW 5:1-2

## After He sat down

JESUS IN NAZARETH · LUKE 4:20

“And He closed the scroll, gave it back to the attendant and sat down, and the eyes of all in the synagogue were fixed on Him.”

JESUS ON THE MOUNTAIN · MATTHEW 5:1-2

“and after He sat down, His disciples came to Him. And He opened His mouth and began to teach them”

FROM THE VIDEO Rabbis taught sitting down, so the moment Jesus sits, the disciples know it's teaching time.

BACKGROUND Matthew shows the same posture by the sea (13:2) and in the temple: 'Every day I used to sit in the temple teaching' (Matthew 26:55). The teachers of the Law 'have seated themselves in the chair of Moses' (Matthew 23:2). Matthew 13:1-2 Matthew 26:55 Matthew 23:2-3

Chrysostom saw a lesson in where Jesus sat: not in a city or a forum, but on a mountain, 'instructing us to do nothing for display' (Homilies on Matthew 15).



FIVE TEACHING BLOCKS · MATTHEW 5-7

## The first of five discourses

📚 MATTHEW 7:28 (LSB) PATTERN

“Now it happened that when Jesus had finished these words, the crowds were astonished at His teaching;”

FROM THE VIDEO The Sermon on the Mount is part one of five discourses in Matthew. Every good Jew would recognize the parallel with the five books of the Torah.

BACKGROUND Matthew closes each block with nearly the same words, 'when Jesus had finished': 7:28, 11:1, 13:53, 19:1 and 26:1. See the five blocks below. Matthew 11:1 Matthew 13:53 Matthew 19:1 Matthew 26:1

DEBATED The five-books link is a well-known proposal. Others see the five blocks as a teaching arrangement without a Torah parallel. The five closing formulas are in the text either way.

◆ Factbook: Moses



WHO IS LISTENING? · MATTHEW 5:1

## The disciples, and the crowds listening in

👥 MATTHEW 5:1 (LSB) AUDIENCE

“Now when Jesus saw the crowds, He went up on the mountain; and after He sat down, His disciples came to Him.”

FROM THE VIDEO The crowds and the disciples are two distinct groups. Even among disciples there were circles: the seventy (Luke 10), the Twelve (Matthew 10), and the three with closer access (Mark 14). Jesus seems to teach His disciples directly while the crowds listen in, 'like flies on the wall.' Luke 10:1 Matthew 10:1-4 Mark 14:33

BACKGROUND Matthew ends the sermon with the crowds 'astonished at His teaching' (7:28-29), so they heard it too.
Matthew 7:28-29



*His disciples came to Him (5:1)*

Fra Angelico, The Sermon on the Mount, about 1437-1446. Convent of San Marco, Florence, via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *When we read the Bible, we really have to do so over the shoulder of a Jew.*
>
> From the video

04 · BACKGROUND

# Five teaching blocks in Matthew

The video promises to point out each discourse as the study goes on. Each one closes with almost the same words.

### 1. The Sermon on the Mount (5–7)

BACKGROUND

Kingdom life. Ends: 'when Jesus had finished these words' (7:28).

### 2. Sending the Twelve (10)

BACKGROUND

Mission. Ends: 'when Jesus had finished giving instructions to His twelve disciples' (11:1).

Matthew 7:28-29

Matthew 11:1

### 3. Parables of the kingdom (13)

BACKGROUND

The kingdom's hidden growth. Ends: 'when Jesus had finished these parables' (13:53).

Matthew 13:53

### 4. Life together (18)

BACKGROUND

Humility and forgiveness among disciples. Ends: 'when Jesus had finished these words' (19:1).

Matthew 19:1

### 5. The end of the age (24-25)

BACKGROUND

Watchfulness and judgment. Ends: 'when Jesus had finished all these words' (26:1).

Matthew 26:1

05 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

# The Beatitudes as a mountain

The video draws 5:3-10 as a chiasm: the same refrain at both ends, climbing to a peak. Here are the eight lines in the LSB, then the Old Testament texts behind them.

MATTHEW 5:3-10 (LSB): THE FRAME IS HIGHLIGHTED; THE VIDEO'S PEAK IS GOLD

A 5:3 Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.

B 5:4 Blessed are those who mourn, for they shall be comforted.

C 5:5 Blessed are the lowly, for they shall inherit the earth.

D 5:6 Blessed are those who hunger and thirst for righteousness, for they shall be satisfied.

D' 5:7 Blessed are the merciful, for they shall receive mercy.

C' 5:8 Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God.

B' 5:9 Blessed are the peacemakers, for they shall be called sons of God.

A' 5:10 Blessed are those who have been persecuted for the sake of righteousness, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.

Eight lines have no single middle, so 5:6 and 5:7 share the top step. The video reads mercy (5:7) as the peak; see Where scholars differ.

ECHO · MATTHEW 5:3-4

## Good news for the afflicted, comfort for those who mourn

ISAIAH · ISAIAH 61:1-2

“The Spirit of Lord Yahweh is upon me / Because Yahweh has anointed me / To bring good news to the afflicted; / He has sent me to bind up the brokenhearted, / To proclaim release to captives / And freedom to prisoners, / To proclaim the favorable year of Yahweh / And the day of vengeance of our God, / To comfort all who mourn,”

JESUS · MATTHEW 5:3-4

“Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven. Blessed are those who mourn, for they shall be comforted.”

FROM THE VIDEO Read 5:3-5 alongside Isaiah 61. By the time of this sermon, Jesus had already read Isaiah 61 in the synagogue and said it was fulfilled in their hearing. Now He ties Isaiah's 'favorable year' to the kingdom of heaven. Luke 4:16-21

BACKGROUND Isaiah also has God dwelling 'with the crushed and lowly of spirit' (Isaiah 57:15), close to 'poor in spirit.' Isaiah 57:15

◆ Factbook: Isaiah ◆ Factbook: Kingdom of heaven

ECHO · MATTHEW 5:5

## The lowly will inherit

PSALM 37 · PSALM 37:11

“But the lowly will inherit the land”

JESUS · MATTHEW 5:5

“Blessed are the lowly, for they shall inherit the earth.”

BACKGROUND Nearly a quotation of Psalm 37:11. The Hebrew word for 'lowly' there ('anav, H6035) is the same word as 'the afflicted' in Isaiah 61:1, so the Psalm and Isaiah 61 meet in this Beatitude. Jesus uses the Greek word of verse 5 (praus) for Himself: 'I am gentle and humble in heart' (Matthew 11:29). Psalm 37:9-11 Matthew 11:29

◆ Factbook: Book of Psalms

THE VIDEO'S PEAK · MATTHEW 5:7

## Blessed are the merciful

DAVID · PSALM 18:25

“With the kind You show Yourself kind; / With the blameless You show Yourself blameless;”

JESUS · MATTHEW 5:7

“Blessed are the merciful, for they shall receive mercy.”

FROM THE VIDEO At the center of the Beatitudes is mercy. This isn't a new concept: Psalm 18:25 says God shows mercy to the merciful. Jesus is describing the kind of person fit for the kingdom of heaven.

BACKGROUND The LSB reads 'kind' in Psalm 18:25; the Hebrew chasid (H2623) is from the same root as chesed, God's 'lovingkindness.' Jesus twice quotes Hosea 6:6, 'I desire compassion, and not sacrifice' (Matthew 9:13; 12:7). Hosea 6:6 Matthew 9:13

ECHO · MATTHEW 5:8

## The pure in heart shall see God

PSALM 24 · PSALM 24:3-4

“Who may ascend into the mountain of Yahweh? / And who may rise in His holy place? / He who has innocent hands and a pure heart,”

JESUS · MATTHEW 5:8

“Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God.”

BACKGROUND On a mountain, Jesus answers the psalm's mountain question: the pure in heart. Augustine called it 'the cleansing of the eye by which God is seen' (On the Sermon on the Mount, Book 2).

◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish)



ECHO · MATTHEW 5:10-12

### Persecuted like the prophets

JESUS, LATER · MATTHEW 23:37

“Jerusalem, Jerusalem, who kills the prophets and stones those who are sent to her!”

JESUS · MATTHEW 5:12

“Rejoice and be glad, for your reward in heaven is great; for in the same way they persecuted the prophets who were before you.”

FROM THE VIDEO Many who seek the righteousness of Isaiah 61 and Matthew 5:3-9 will actually be persecuted.

BACKGROUND One Old Testament example: Zechariah son of Jehoiada was stoned 'in the court of the house of Yahweh' for calling the people back (2 Chronicles 24:20-21), Jesus later speaks of 'the blood of Zechariah' (Matthew 23:35); many identify him with this man, though Matthew calls him 'the son of Berechiah.' 2 Chronicles 24:20-21 Matthew 23:34-35

◆ Factbook: Righteousness

06 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

## Salt and light

Two pictures from Israel's worship: the covenant of salt and the lampstand in God's house.



COVENANT · MATTHEW 5:13

### The salt of the earth

THE LAW · LEVITICUS 2:13

“Every grain offering of yours, moreover, you shall season with salt, so that the salt of the covenant of your God shall not be lacking from your grain offering; with all your offerings you shall bring salt near.”

JESUS · MATTHEW 5:13

“You are the salt of the earth; but if the salt has become tasteless, how will it be made salty again?”

FROM THE VIDEO Salt makes a Jew remember the covenant of salt. Salt preserves what it touches, so it pictures the permanent relationship God keeps with His people. They carry that preservation wherever they go.

BACKGROUND 'An everlasting covenant of salt before Yahweh' (Numbers 18:19); the kingdom given to David 'by a covenant of salt' (2 Chronicles 13:5). Mark's version: 'Have salt in yourselves, and be at peace with one another' (Mark 9:50). Numbers 18:19 2 Chronicles 13:5 Mark 9:50

Chrysostom read 'salt of the earth' as a sign that 'all human nature' had lost its savor through sin, and the apostles were sent to preserve it (Homilies on Matthew 15).



GOD'S HOUSE · MATTHEW 5:15

## A lamp on the lampstand

THE TABERNACLE · EXODUS 25:31

“Then you shall make a lampstand of pure gold. The lampstand, its base, and its shaft are to be made of hammered work; its cups, its bulbs, and its flowers shall be of the same piece.”

JESUS · MATTHEW 5:15

“nor does anyone light a lamp and put it under a basket, but on the lampstand, and it gives light to all who are in the house.”

FROM THE VIDEO A Jew would think of the temple. The temple is called 'the house,' and its lampstand, the menorah, was fashioned to look like a tree, with flowers and fruit, to recall the tree of life in Eden. Jesus tells His disciples: you are to be this tree to the world.

BACKGROUND Exodus describes cups 'shaped like almond blossoms,' with bulbs and flowers on six branches (25:31-34). The Greek word for 'lampstand' in 5:15 (lychnia, G3087) is the word Hebrews uses for the tabernacle lampstand (Hebrews 9:2). Exodus 25:31-34 Hebrews 9:2 Genesis 2:9

DEBATED The tree shape is in Exodus itself. The link to the tree of life is an interpretation that many readers find persuasive; the video's 'Jewish documents' are not named.

◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish) ◆ Factbook: Garden of Eden



SEEN BY ALL · MATTHEW 5:14, 16

## A city set on a hill

ISAIAH · ISAIAH 2:2

“The mountain of the house of Yahweh / Will be established as the head of the mountains, / And will be lifted up above the hills; / And all the nations will stream to it.”

JESUS · MATTHEW 5:14

“You are the light of the world. A city set on a hill cannot be hidden;”

FROM THE VIDEO Pair the salt with the lampstand and you see the point: God's people live out their relationship with God, and that offers life to those who recognize its light.

BACKGROUND Isaiah's hill is Zion, where the nations come to learn God's ways (Isaiah 2:2-3). Jesus' disciples are to be seen, 'that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father who is in heaven' (5:16). Isaiah 2:2-3 Matthew 5:16

Chrysostom: 'For you shall be as conspicuous to all as a city set on the ridge of a hill, as a candle in a house on the candlestick, giving light' (Homilies on Matthew 15).

> *“Jesus brings that imagery to His disciples and He says: you are to be this tree to the world.*
>
> From the video

# Not to abolish, but to fulfill

Jesus and the Law, and the 'secret enemy' named in 5:20.

NOT TO ABOLISH · MATTHEW 5:17

## To fulfill the Law and the Prophets

📖 MATTHEW 5:17 (LSB)

FULFILL

“Do not think that I came to abolish the Law or the Prophets; I did not come to abolish but to fulfill.”

FROM THE VIDEO 'Abolish' and 'fulfill' are Hebrew idioms about interpretation: to fulfill the Law was to interpret Torah properly; to abolish it was to misinterpret it, making it void. Jesus came to teach how to live up to God's commands, which the religious teachers were no longer doing.

DEBATED This idiom reading is one view. Many read 'fulfill' (plēroō, G4137) in Matthew's usual sense: bringing to completion what Scripture points to, as in 'what was spoken by the Lord through the prophet would be fulfilled' (1:22; 2:15). Both readings say Jesus upholds the Law; they differ on how. Matthew 1:22 Matthew 2:15 Matthew 3:15

Chrysostom: 'The prophets He fulfilled, inasmuch as He confirmed by His actions all that had been said concerning Him ... But the law He fulfilled, not in one way only, but in a second and third also' (Homilies on Matthew 16).

◆ Factbook: Jesus Christ

EVERY STROKE · MATTHEW 5:18-19

## Not the smallest letter or stroke

✒️ MATTHEW 5:18 (LSB)

STANDS

“For truly I say to you, until heaven and earth pass away, not the smallest letter or stroke shall pass from the Law until all is accomplished.”

BACKGROUND 'Smallest letter' is iōta (G2503), the Greek name for the smallest Hebrew letter, yod (י). 'Stroke' is keraia (G2762), literally a little horn: the tiny mark that tells one Hebrew letter from another. Whoever 'annuls one of the least of these commandments, and teaches others to do the same' is least in the kingdom (5:19). Matthew 5:19

THE SECRET ENEMY · MATTHEW 5:20

## Righteousness that surpasses the scribes and Pharisees

JESUS, LATER · MATTHEW 23:27-28

“For you are like whitewashed tombs which on the outside appear beautiful, but inside they are full of dead men’s bones and all uncleanness. In this way, you also outwardly appear righteous to men, but inwardly you are full of hypocrisy and lawlessness.”

JESUS · MATTHEW 5:20

“For I say to you that unless your righteousness surpasses that of the scribes and Pharisees, you will not enter the kingdom of heaven.”

FROM THE VIDEO These are the antagonists. Not the ill-informed: the people who were supposed to know God's word and live it, but were pulling others into their own blindness. The protagonists are the humble, pure, merciful peacemakers of the Beatitudes.

BACKGROUND Jesus is not lowering the bar. The next verses (5:21-48) show what 'surpassing' righteousness looks like: anger, lust and love for enemies, all matters of the heart. Matthew 5:21-22 Matthew 7:21

◆ Factbook: Pharisees ◆ Factbook: Righteousness

> *"It is possible for people to live their lives thinking they are obedient to God's commands and still not enter His kingdom.*
>
> From the video: the lesson for the original audience

08

# Who's who on the hillside

What the video says, then a short background note.

## Jesus

VIDEO Sits to teach like a rabbi and gives God's commands from a mountain like Moses; the prophet Moses promised.

BACKGROUND In Matthew, Jesus teaches 'as one having authority, and not as their scribes' (7:29).

Matthew 7:28-29 | Deuteronomy 18:15 | ◆ Jesus Christ

## The disciples

VIDEO Jesus' original audience: He is teaching them what it means to be sons of God (5:9) and bearers of the kingdom.

BACKGROUND Only four have been called by name so far (4:18-22). The Twelve are listed in 10:2-4.

Matthew 4:18-22 | Matthew 10:2-4

## The crowds

VIDEO A distinct group, gathered from 'the worst places of darkness,' welcome to listen in.

BACKGROUND They came from Galilee, the Decapolis, Jerusalem, Judea and beyond the Jordan (4:25). At the end they are 'astonished' (7:28).

Matthew 4:25 | Matthew 7:28 | ◆ Galilee | ◆ Decapolis

## The scribes and Pharisees

VIDEO The 'secret enemy': people who strove to obey the Torah fully, yet were unchanged in heart.

BACKGROUND Scribes were experts who copied and taught the Law; Pharisees were a lay movement devoted to careful keeping of it. Jesus tells His disciples to do what they teach from Moses, but not what they do (Matthew 23:2-3).

Matthew 23:2-3 | Matthew 23:27-28 | ◆ Pharisees

## Moses

VIDEO Gave God's commands from a mountaintop and promised a prophet like himself.

BACKGROUND At Sinai Moses went up to receive 'the stone tablets with the law' (Exodus 24:12).

Exodus 19:3 | Exodus 24:12 | ◆ Moses | ◆ Mount Sinai (Horeb)

## Isaiah

VIDEO Isaiah 61 stands behind the first Beatitudes, and Jesus had already announced its fulfillment.

BACKGROUND The anointed one of Isaiah 61 brings good news, comfort and 'oaks of righteousness' (61:3).

Isaiah 61:1-3 | Luke 4:16-21 | ◆ Isaiah

09 · BACKGROUND

# Around the lake

The video does not name the mountain. Gold pins are background: the traditional sites and the towns nearby.




Named in the video · Background

Positions of towns from their known sites. The mountain of Matthew 5:1 is not named; both hills shown are traditions. Coastline of the lake and rivers: OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL); land: Natural Earth (public domain).

### Mount of Beatitudes BACKGROUND

The traditional site, a hill above Tabgha on the northwest shore. Matthew says only 'the mountain' (5:1).

### Capernaum BACKGROUND

Jesus' home base by the lake (4:13), a short walk from the traditional site.

◆ Factbook: Capernaum

**Tabgha** BACKGROUND
A shore spot with springs below the traditional Mount of Beatitudes.

**Horns of Hattin** BACKGROUND
A twin-peaked hill west of the lake, named as the mountain in some medieval traditions.

**Hippos** BACKGROUND
A Decapolis city on a flat-topped hill across the lake. Some suggest a hilltop city like it, visible from the shore, behind 'a city set on a hill' (5:14).

◆ Factbook: Decapolis

**Magdala** BACKGROUND
A fishing town on the west shore, famous for salted fish.

**Tiberias** BACKGROUND
Herod Antipas' new capital, founded around AD 20.

**Chorazin** BACKGROUND
A hill town above Capernaum, later rebuked by Jesus (11:21).

**Bethsaida** BACKGROUND
'The city of Andrew and Peter' (John 1:44).

**Nazareth** BACKGROUND
Jesus' hometown, where He read Isaiah 61 in the synagogue (Luke 4:16-21).

◆ Factbook: Nazareth

10

# Key terms

## Beatitudes

BACKGROUND

From Latin beatus, 'blessed': the eight 'Blessed are...' sayings of 5:3-10, plus the direct 'Blessed are you' of 5:11-12.

## Blessed

BACKGROUND

Not a wish but a declaration: these people are in a happy, favored state before God. The same opening as Psalm 1:1, 'How blessed is the man...'

## Chiasm

VIDEO

A mirrored pattern (A B C ... C' B' A') where the outer lines frame the center. The video draws it as a mountain: climb from the first line to the peak, then down. 'Kingdom of heaven' in verses 3 and 10 forms the frame.

## Kingdom of heaven

BACKGROUND

The theme of the sermon. In the LSB the phrase appears six times in five verses of Matthew 5-7 (5:3, 10, 19, 20; 7:21), and 'kingdom' alone twice more (6:10, 33).

◆ Factbook: Kingdom of heaven

## Covenant of salt

## Lampstand (menorah)

VIDEO

A permanent, unbreakable covenant (Numbers 18:19; 2 Chronicles 13:5). Salt was added to every grain offering (Leviticus 2:13).

VIDEO

The seven-lamp gold lampstand of the tabernacle and temple, made with almond-blossom cups, bulbs and flowers (Exodus 25:31-40).

◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish)

### The Law and the Prophets

BACKGROUND

A way of naming the Scriptures (what we call the Old Testament). It comes back at 7:12 and 22:40.

### Scribes

BACKGROUND

Experts in the Law who copied, taught and applied it. Matthew often pairs them with the Pharisees.

◆ Factbook: Pharisees

### Seventy

VIDEO

The video's example of a wider circle of disciples (Luke 10:1). Some manuscripts of Luke read 'seventy-two.'

II · BACKGROUND

## Hebrew and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew).

### μακάριος

***makarios*** G3107

Blessed, happy, favored by God. Begins each of the Beatitudes. Look up: BDAG, μακάριος.

Greek · Matt 5:3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10

### πτωχός

***ptōchos*** G4434

Poor, destitute; 'poor in spirit' is the person who knows they have nothing to bring before God.

Greek · Matt 5:3

### πραΰς

***praus*** G4239

Gentle, humble, lowly (LSB 'lowly'). Jesus uses it of Himself: 'gentle and humble in heart.'

Greek · Matt 5:5; 11:29

### ἐλεήμων

***eleēmōn*** G1655

Merciful, compassionate. The promise uses the related verb eleeō (G1653), 'receive mercy.'

Greek · Matt 5:7

### καθαρός

### εἰρηνοποιός

***katharos*** `G2513`

Clean, pure; 'pure in heart' is inner, undivided devotion.

Greek · Matt 5:8

***eirēnopoios*** `G1518`

Peacemaker (eirēnē, peace + poieō, make). Found only here in the New Testament.

Greek · Matt 5:9

## δικαιοσύνη

***dikaiosynē*** `G1343`

Righteousness: right standing and right living before God. A key word of the sermon (5:6, 10, 20; 6:1, 33).

Greek · Matt 5:6, 10, 20

◆ Factbook: Righteousness

## ἅλας

***halas*** `G217`

Salt.

Greek · Matt 5:13

## μωραίνω

***mōrainō*** `G3471`

To become foolish; of salt, to become tasteless (LSB 'become tasteless'). The same root as mōros, 'fool' (5:22).

Greek · Matt 5:13

## λυχνία

***lychnia*** `G3087`

Lampstand. Hebrews uses it for the tabernacle lampstand.

Greek · Matt 5:15; Heb 9:2

◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish)

## καταλύω

***katalyō*** `G2647`

To tear down, destroy, abolish. Used of the temple's stones being 'torn down' (24:2).

Greek · Matt 5:17

## πληρόω

***plēroō*** `G4137`

To fill, complete, fulfill. Matthew's word for Scripture coming true (1:22; 2:15; 4:14). Look up: BDAG, πληρόω.

Greek · Matt 5:17

## ἰῶτα

***iōta*** `G2503`

Iota, the smallest Greek letter, standing for the Hebrew yod (LSB 'smallest letter').

Greek · Matt 5:18

## κεραία

***keraia*** `G2762`

Little horn: a tiny stroke on a letter (LSB 'stroke').

Greek · Matt 5:18

## עָנָו

***'anav*** `H6035`

Afflicted, humble, lowly. Isaiah's 'afflicted' and the psalm's 'lowly' are the same word.

Hebrew · Isa 61:1; Ps 37:11

## חָסִיד

***chasid*** `H2623`

Kind, faithful, godly; related to chesed, 'lovingkindness.' Other versions: 'merciful.' Look up: BDB, חָסִיד.

Hebrew · Ps 18:25

מֶלַח

***melach*** H4417

Salt; 'the salt of the covenant.'

Hebrew · Lev 2:13

מְנוֹרָה

***menorah*** H4501

Lampstand: the menorah.

Hebrew · Exod 25:31

◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish)

בָּשַׂר

***basar*** H1319

To bring good news (LSB 'bring good news'), the Hebrew behind the gospel idea.

Hebrew · Isa 61:1

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# Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED **Facts most interpreters agree on**

### Teaching seated

In the synagogue a reader stood to read Scripture and sat to teach (Luke 4:16, 20). Jesus' seated teaching on the mountain signals a formal lesson.

### Salt in the ancient world

Salt seasoned food and preserved fish and meat. Much of the salt from the Dead Sea area was mixed with other minerals; if the salt washed out, what was left was tasteless, 'no longer good for anything' (5:13).

### Lamps and baskets

A household lamp was a small clay oil lamp. A modios (5:15) was a grain measure of about 8.7 liters (two gallons); putting it over a lamp would smother the light.

### Scribes and Pharisees

The Pharisees were a respected lay movement devoted to keeping the Law in daily life, with traditions about tithing, purity and the Sabbath. Scribes were trained experts in the Law; many were Pharisees. Jesus' sharpest words are for those who knew the most.

### Where was the mountain?

Matthew does not name it. Since the 4th century pilgrims have honored a hill near Tabgha; a church built there in 1938 marks the traditional Mount of Beatitudes. Some medieval traditions pointed to the Horns of Hattin.

SOURCED

## Early witnesses

> *The eighth, as it were, returns to the starting-point, because it shows and commends what is complete and perfect: therefore in the first and in the eighth the kingdom of heaven is named*

Augustine of Hippo, c. AD 393. On the Sermon on the Mount, Book 1, on Matthew 5:10. Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers, series 1, vol. 6 (public domain). Augustine saw the same frame the video points to, though he read the eight as rising steps, not a mountain with mercy at the peak. He opens by calling the sermon 'a perfect standard of the Christian life.'

> *What is meant by the poor in spirit? The humble and contrite in mind.*

John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 15, on Matthew 5:3. Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers, series 1, vol. 10 (public domain).

DEBATED

## Where scholars differ

### Where is the peak of the Beatitudes?

Eight lines have no single middle. The video reads mercy (5:7) as the peak. Others see two sets of four, each ending with 'righteousness' (5:6, 10), or a rising ladder of virtues (Augustine). All agree on the frame: the kingdom of heaven in 5:3 and 5:10.

### Are the five discourses a new Torah?

Matthew clearly marks five teaching blocks. Whether he meant them to mirror the five books of Moses, or simply arranged Jesus' teaching in five blocks, is debated.

### What does 'fulfill' mean?

The video: properly interpret. Others: bring to its intended goal (as prophecy is fulfilled), or perfectly obey. Most hold that Jesus affirms the Law's authority while showing its deepest intent.

### Who is the sermon for?

The video: the disciples, with the crowds listening in. Others stress that the crowds are addressed too (7:28-29). Both see the sermon as a description of life in the kingdom, not a way to earn it.

CAREFUL READING

## Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- The video counts 'kingdom of heaven' five times in the whole sermon. In the LSB the phrase appears six times in five verses (5:3, 10, 19 twice, 20; 7:21), with 'kingdom' alone in 6:10 and 6:33. The theme still stands.
- Eight Beatitudes have no single center line; 5:6 and 5:7 sit together in the middle. Mercy as the peak is the video's reading (see Where scholars differ).
- The video pairs 'the brokenhearted' in Isaiah 61:1 with 'the meek.' The closer match is 'the afflicted': the same Hebrew word ('anav) as 'the lowly will inherit the land' in Psalm 37:11, which 5:5 echoes. That makes the video's Isaiah 61 link stronger.
- Psalm 18:25 in the LSB reads 'With the kind You show Yourself kind'; 'merciful' comes from other versions. The idea is the same.

- 'Rabbis always taught sitting down' is a little strong; sitting to teach is well attested (Luke 4:20; Matthew 23:2; 26:55), but Jesus also taught as He walked.
- The captions say 'Matthew 3-5' and 'Isaiah 6 1'; the video means Matthew 5:3-5 and Isaiah 61.

13 · BACKGROUND

# From Sinai to the hillside

Coral dots mark what Matthew 5:1-20 echoes or tells. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

C. 1446 OR 1260 BC DEBATED
**Moses goes up the mountain to receive the Law**
Exodus 19:3 *Echo: 5:1*

C. 1000 BC
**David: 'With the kind You show Yourself kind'**
Psalm 18:25 *Echo: 5:7*

C. 700 BC
**Isaiah: good news to the afflicted, comfort to all who mourn**
Isaiah 61:1-3 *Echo: 5:3-4*

C. AD 28 DEBATED
**Jesus reads Isaiah 61 in Nazareth: 'Today this Scripture has been fulfilled'**
Luke 4:16-21

SOON AFTER
**The Sermon on the Mount begins**
Matthew 5:1-20 *This episode*

LATER
**'Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees': whitewashed tombs**
Matthew 23:27-28

C. AD 390
**Chrysostom preaches on Matthew in Antioch**
Matthew 5:3

C. AD 393
**Augustine writes On the Sermon on the Mount**
Matthew 5:10

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# Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

Luke 6:20-23
Luke's Beatitudes, in the Sermon on the Plain

Isaiah 61:1-3
Good news to the afflicted; comfort for mourners

ADDED

ADDED

Psalm 37:9-11
The lowly will inherit the land
ADDED

Psalm 24:3-6
Who may ascend the mountain of Yahweh?
ADDED

Psalm 1:1-3
Another 'blessed' that begins a book
ADDED

Exodus 19:1-6
Moses on the mountain; Israel as a kingdom of priests
ADDED

Numbers 18:19; 2 Chronicles 13:5
The covenant of salt
ADDED

Exodus 25:31-40
The lampstand with almond blossoms
ADDED

Isaiah 2:2-5
The nations stream to the mountain of Yahweh
ADDED

Romans 3:31
'Do we then abolish the Law through faith?'
ADDED

Matthew 23:1-28
The woes against the scribes and Pharisees
ADDED

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# Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1 ☐ The video's homework: look for repeated refrains (chiasms) in Matthew 1-4. What did you find?

2 ☐ Read Isaiah 61:1-3 beside Matthew 5:3-5. Which line of Isaiah helps you most to understand a Beatitude?

3 ☐ Salt preserves and the lampstand gives light in God's house. Where are you meant to be 'salt' and 'light' this week?

4 ☐ How could someone obey commands and still not be changed in heart? What would surpassing righteousness look like in your life?

5 ☐ The video's question for today: do we see the 'scribes and Pharisees' pattern in our own churches and circles of influence? How can we spot it in ourselves first?

6 ☐ Should churches speak mainly to disciples, with others listening in, or shape the message for visitors? What does Matthew 5:1-2 suggest to you?

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# Application

FROM THE VIDEO

The lesson for the original audience: it is possible to live thinking you are obedient to God's commands and still not enter His kingdom. The difference is the qualities of the heart (humble, pure, merciful, a peacemaker), and that is what Jesus is after. For you today: if Jesus warned against people who think they obey but are not changed in heart, is that still possible today, and something we need to wrestle with as we survey our own churches and circles of influence?

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

the Beatitudes begin with need, not achievement: the poor in spirit, those who mourn, those who hunger. Surpassing righteousness starts by admitting we have nothing to bring. Pray Psalm 24:3-4 this week: ask God for 'innocent hands and a pure heart,' then look for one place to show mercy.

> *"The difference comes down to the qualities of the heart, and that's what Jesus is after anyway: the heart.*
>
> From the video

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# Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

◆ Jesus Christ ◆ Moses ◆ Mount Sinai (Horeb) ◆ Isaiah ◆ Kingdom of heaven ◆ Righteousness ◆ Pharisees ◆ Temple (Jewish) ◆ Garden of Eden ◆ Book of Psalms ◆ Book of Deuteronomy ◆ Galilee ◆ Capernaum ◆ Decapolis ◆ Nazareth ◆ John Chrysostom

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Offline copy. Live page: https://shea-nelson.github.io/workout-app/bible/matthew-6/